

CSS Final Project: What's Today?

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2025-12-09

Introduction

- Problem: People often feel indecisive or don't know which leisure activities or hobbies might fit their interests, time, or location.
- Solution: Our app "What's Today?"
- Users input age, time of day, day of the week, and location to receive general leisure activities and hobbies.
 - ATUS data
- Secondary Component: NYC meetup.com events
 - Join a group, try something new, be spontaneous!
- Interactive dashboard and dynamic tables and visualizations that update immediately with user selections

Data and Methodology - ATUS

- American Time Use Survey (ATUS)
 - Existing datasets (US Bureau of Labor Statistics)
 - Measures the amount of time people spend doing various activities
- Methods
 - Merging Resp, Roster, & Activity files
 - Selecting relevant columns, recoding numerical codes to text labels
 - Descriptive statistics (frequency distribution, mean duration, etc.)

Data and Methodology - Meetup.com

- Meetup.com
- Scraped the website
 - Name, Date & time
 - Group/organization
 - Several categories
- Chromote
 - Package for web page interaction
 - Headless Chrome session

Data and Methodology - Application

- GitHub Repository
 - Allowed for version control and collaboration
- R Shiny
 - Open-source R package
 - Build interactive web applications directly from R
- Global.R
 - Loaded in libraries and data
 - `read_csv()` and `bind_rows()`
- UI.R
 - Created visual layout for user input and output
 - `selectInput()`, `plotlyOutput()`, `DTOutput()`, `titlePanel()`
- Server.R
 - App logic, filtering, and rendering outputs
 - ATUS Data: filtered by user selections
 - Meetup.com Data: Filtered by event category

Application Demonstration

What's Today

What's Today?

Exploring Activities [Top Activities for Students & Non-students](#) [NYC meetup.com Events](#)

Filters

Select your age:

All

Select time:

All

Select day option:

☒ All

☐ weekends

☐ weekdays

Select your location:

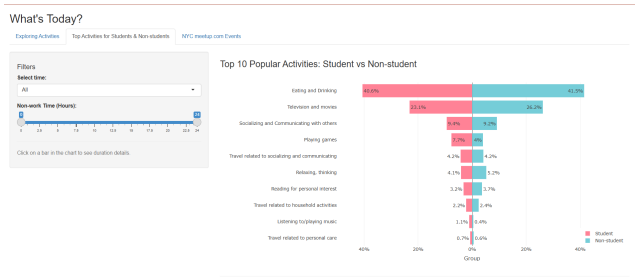
All

[Click to zoom in more detailed activity options](#)

Exploring Activities



What's Today



What's Today

What's Today?

[Exploring Activities](#)[Top Activities for Students & Non-students](#)[NYC meetup.com Events](#)

Categories

Select Activity Category:

Filter for local NYC meetup.com events matching your interests

Local NYC meetup.com Events

Showing NYC meetup.com General events

event_name	group	date	category
1 HoliGay Extravaganza 9!	by Prans & Pease Queer Meetups	Sat, Dec 6 - 3:00 PM EST	General
2 Unreal NYC December Event	by Unreal NYC Con4.9	Thu, Dec 4 - 6:30 PM EST	General
3 AI/ML Conversations Meetup: Smart CPU Offloading for Scalable LLM Inference	by New York AI/ML Conversations con4.5	Monthly • Tue, Dec 9 - 5:30 PM EST	General
4 Keto for Mental Health Support Group	by Keto Lifestyle for mental health con4.7	Thu, Dec 4 - 6:00 PM EST	General
5 Flow State: The Art of AI Automation with n8n & Zapier	by NYC User Experience & Digital Product Design con4.4	Thu, Dec 4 - 6:30 PM EST	General
6 Bitcoin Developers' Socio-c Seminar 153	by BitDev NYC con4.9	Thu, Dec 4 - 6:00 PM EST	General
7 Google NY Site Reliability Engineering (SRE) Tech Talks, 16 Dec 2025	by New York Site Reliability Engineering Tech Talks con4.7	Tue, Dec 16 - 8:00 PM EST	General
8 [Register on Luma] Tech and Startup Networking Mixer	by Tech Startups of New York con4.3	Thu, Dec 4 - 5:00 PM EST	General
9 Start your weekend at New York Historical's library	by Silent Book Club NYC con4.7	Fri, Dec 12 - 6:30 PM EST	General
10 NY Professionals Happy Hour	by NY Young Professionals con4.5	Thu, Dec 4 - 7:00 PM EST	General

Showing 1 to 10 of 90 entries

Previous

1

2

3

4

5

...

9

Next

Takeaways

- Radhika:
 - Scraping for HTML can be tedious
 - Multiple categories of events, different HTMLS
- Somin:
 - Add a visualization to explore how activities change depending on who they are spending their leisure time with
- Emily:
 - Github helped work in a group, but I had issues pushing and pulling and figuring out the working directory
 - No weather/geographical capabilities due to complexity of app code for dynamic data like weather